

Priming

What is it?

Subtle cues influence how people think, feel, or behave before they consciously make decisions.

History

Studied deep in cognitive psychology since **1983**, revealing that small triggers like words, images, colours, or sounds can shape future behavior without conscious awareness.

The Psychology Behind It

Exposure to a stimulus influences response to a later stimulus.

The brain subconsciously connects cues with emotions, memories, or expectations.

So positive words, visual framing, or emotional imagery can shift decisions, attitudes, and actions silently in the background.

Why It Matters

- Can be misused or manipulative
- Creates false assumptions when poorly applied
- Has strong influence power on decisions and perception

How to Apply It

- Use positive emotional cues
- Apply color psychology and visual framing intentionally
- Keep visual + verbal cues aligned (no mixed signals)
- Apply priming ethically and transparently
- Focus on improving user experience, not tricking behavior

Theory in Action

Facebook “Memories” resurfaces emotional past moments to trigger sentiment and re-engagement.

Coca-Cola campaigns often associate the brand with positive emotions and joyful moments.

Final Thought

Priming is powerful. When used with ethics and intention, small cues can guide users toward better emotions, clearer decisions, and more meaningful product experiences.

